

Highs and lows of the men's T20 Asia Cup

The first men's Asia Cup cricket tournament was played in April 1984 in Sharjah, UAE. Since then, cricket fans have enjoyed 16 exciting editions of this tournament. Fourteen of these were played in the ODI format, while the 2016 and 2022 editions were in the T20 format, building excitement for the upcoming T20 World Cups. With the 2026 T20 World Cup just around the corner in India, the Asian Cricket Council (ACC) decided to shake things up and switch from the usual 50-over format to the faster-paced T20. The 2016 men's Asia Cup, held between February 19 and March 6 in Bangladesh, brought together eight talented teams across 17 matches played in Fatullah and Mirpur.

The qualifying round saw the UAE, Afghanistan, Oman, and Hong Kong battling it out for a spot in the main event. The UAE came out on top to join India, Bangladesh, Pakistan, and Sri Lanka in the main tournament. The competition was fierce, but it was India which triumphed, defeating Bangladesh by eight wickets

with seven balls to spare in a thrilling final in Mirpur. Shikhar Dhawan was named the Player of the final for his impressive 60-run contribution — the only fifty-plus score in the match.

As the cricket world buzzed with anticipation for the 2022 T20 World Cup in Australia, the Asia Cup returned to the T20 format to thrill fans once more. From August 20 to September 11, 2022, the tournament featured 19 action-packed T20 matches, spread across Al Amerat in Oman, as well as Dubai and Sharjah in the UAE.

The qualifying round was filled with excitement, as Hong Kong, Kuwait, the UAE, and Singapore all vied for a coveted spot. Hong Kong emerged as the top contender and joined the main event. In a memorable final in Dubai, Sri Lanka shone brightly, defeating Pakistan by 23 runs. Bhanuka Rajapaksa's unbeaten 71 made him the Player of the final, the perfect ending to a fantastic tournament.

An overview of the performance of teams and players during the first two Asia Cup T20 tournaments.

Title winners

No	Period	Host	Result in the final	Result	Venue	Player of the tournament
1	Feb-Mar 2016	Bangladesh	India beat Bangladesh	by 8 wkts (7 balls to spare)	Mirpur	Sabbir Rahman (Ban)
2	Aug-Sep 2022	Oman/UAE	Sri Lanka beat Pakistan	by 23 runs	Dubai	Wanindu Hasaranga (SL)

Match result summary of the eight participating sides in 2025

Team	Period	M	W	L	Win%	Titles won	Runner-up
India	2016-2022	10	8	2	80.00	1	—
Sri Lanka	2016-2022	10	6	4	60.00	1	—
Afghanistan	2016-2022	8	4	4	50.00	—	—
Pakistan	2016-2022	10	5	5	50.00	—	1
Bangladesh	2016-2022	7	3	4	42.86	—	1
UAE	2016-2022	10	4	6	40.00	—	—
Hong Kong	2016-2022	8	3	5	37.50	—	—
Oman	2022-	3	1	2	33.33	—	—

Note: Kuwait (won 2, lost 1) and Singapore (lost all three) are the other sides to participate in the tournament in 2022.

Big victories

By runs	Winner	Loser	Venue	Date
155	Pak	HK	Sharah	2-9-2022
101	Ind	Afg	Dubai	8-9-2022
By wickets	Winner	Loser	Venue	Date
9	Ind	UAE	Mirpur	3-3-2016

Highest totals

Total	(ov)	For	Opp	Venue	Date	Result
212/2	(20)	Ind	Afg	Dubai	8-9-2022	Won
193/2	(20)	Pak	HK	Sharjah	2-9-2022	Won
192/2	(20)	Ind	HK	Dubai	31-8-2022	Won

Lowest totals

Total	(ov)	For	Opp	Venue	Date	Result
38/10	(10.4)	HK	Pak	Sharjah	2-9-2022	Lost
81/9	(20)	UAE	Ind	Mirpur	3-3-2016	Lost
82/10	(17.4)	UAE	Ban	Mirpur	26-2-2016	Lost

Narrow victories

By runs	Winner	Loser	Venue	Date
5	Oman	HK	Fatullah	19-2-2016
8	HK	Sing	Al Amerat	8-9-2022
By wickets	Winner	Loser	Venue	Date
1	Kuw	UAE	Al Amerat	21-8-2022
1	Pak	Afg	Sharjah	7-9-2022